

HARDWARE HACKATHON

Build a working hardware prototype against the clock

Team Size	2-4 members	Entry Fee	Rs. 400
Prize	To be announced	Venue	To be announced

Objective

Teams design, build, and demonstrate a working hardware prototype addressing a given theme or an open problem statement, within the allotted time.

Format

- Duration: typically 12 to 24 hours, announced along with the schedule.
- Themes/problem statements will be released at the start of the hackathon; teams may also be allowed to pick an open innovation track.
- Teams must bring their own components, sensors, and tools; a basic component store or lab access may be provided (details announced separately).
- Use of pre-built kits is allowed, but the core logic, integration, and majority of the build must be done during the hackathon window.

Judging Criteria

- Innovation and originality of the idea.
- Technical execution and functionality of the working prototype.
- Practicality and real-world relevance of the solution.
- Quality of the final presentation and demonstration to the judges.

Submission

- Teams must submit a short project report/slide deck and demonstrate the working prototype live to the judging panel.
- Partially working prototypes may still be judged, with credit given for the effort and design, at the judges' discretion.

General Conduct

- Participants must carry a valid college ID card at all times during the event.
- Any form of misconduct, use of abusive language, or unsporting behaviour will lead to immediate disqualification.
- Decisions of the judges and organizing committee are final and binding.
- The organizers are not responsible for any damage, loss, or injury during the event; participants take part at their own risk.
- Participants must report to the venue at least 30 minutes before their scheduled slot.

Safety Guidelines

- Sharp tools, open flames, lasers, and hazardous chemicals are strictly prohibited unless pre-approved by the organizers.
- All electrical connections must be properly insulated; loose wiring may lead to disqualification on safety grounds.
- Batteries must be handled with care; short-circuits or overheating incidents must be reported immediately.
- Safety gear (gloves/goggles, where applicable) is recommended and may be mandatory for certain sub-tasks.

Disqualification Criteria

- Missing the reporting or check-in deadline for your slot.
- Using a robot/device or submission that does not meet the size, weight, or component specifications above.
- Remote interference with another team's device or run.
- Plagiarism or use of an undisclosed pre-built solution where original work was required.
- Any attempt to bribe, threaten, or unduly influence judges or coordinators.

These rules are provisional and general in nature. The organizing committee may issue clarifications, additional rounds, or minor changes closer to the event date; the latest version will always be posted on the PLASMA 2K26 website.